



Save • Borrow • Grow

STRATEGIC PLAN 2026–2030



Graphical Representation of SHG Strategic Plan



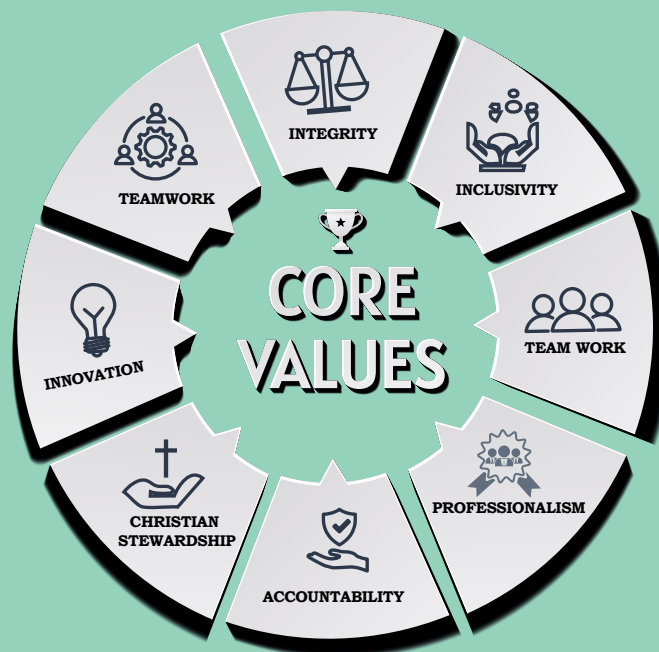
VISION:

To be a leading Christian based financial service provider committed to promoting inclusive, ethical, and innovative socio-economic empowerment.



MISSION:

To empower members through savings mobilization, provision of affordable credit, financial literacy, and value-based service delivery supported by modern technology.



STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES

- Objective 1:** Increase membership by 20% in 2026 and 2027 and by 10% thereafter (Baseline = 376 members)
- Objective 2:** Grow share capital by 25% annually (Baseline = KES 87 million)
- Objective 3:** Increase loan uptake by 6% annually
- Objective 4:** Enhance governance, risk management and human resource capacity
- Objective 5:** Enhance application of ICT in management decision making and service delivery
- Objective 6:** Promote environmental sustainability and positive social impact



**HIS GRACE THE MOST REV. ARCHBISHOP PHILIP A.
ANYOLO – METROPOLITAN ARCHBISHOP OF NAIROBI**



**REV. FR. MARTIN NJIHIA NG'ANG'A
FATHER IN CHARGE QUEEN OF APOSTLES PARISH – RUARAKA**

SHG Managament Committee



SAMUEL WAINAINA
Chairman- Management Committee



RAPHAEL KABANDO
Vice-Chairman
Chairman- Capacity
Building, Strategy and
Development Committee



JOSEPHINE NJAU
Executive Secretary
Chairperson- Risk, Audit
and Compliance
Committee



ELIZABETH THIAKA
Treasurer
Chairperson- Finance and
Budget Committee



SULEIMAN CHEGE
Member
Secretary- Capacity
Building, Strategy and
Development Committee



NAOMI MUNGAI
Member
Secretary- Risk, Audit and
Compliance Committee



MARY NJOROGE
Member
Secretary- Finance and
Budget Committee

Table of Contents

Acknowledgement.....	vii
Abbreviations and Acronyms	viii
EXECUTIVE SUMMARY.....	ix

CHAPTER ONE INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background.....	1
1.2 Rationale for developing the Plan	2
1.3 Organization of the Plan.....	3

CHAPTER TWO KENYA'S DEVELOPMENT AGENDA

2.1 Introduction	4
2.2 The National Development Agenda.....	4
2.3 Informal and Non-Formal Financial Service Groups	5
2.4 Caritas Nairobi and SHGs role in the National Development Agenda	5

CHAPTER THREE SITUATION ANALYSIS

3.1 Review of Past Performance.....	7
3.2 Internal Environment Analysis.....	10
3.3 External Environment Analysis	11
3.4 Stakeholder Analysis	14
3.5 The SWOT Analysis	16
3.6 Strategic Issues/Priority Areas	18

CHAPTER FOUR STRATEGIC DIRECTION

4.1 Introduction.....	19
4.2 Vision Statement	19
4.3 Mission Statement	19
4.4 Value Statements.....	20
4.5 Rallying Call (Motto)	20
4.6 Performance Objectives and Strategies.....	20

CHAPTER FIVE PLAN IMPLEMENTATION

5.1 The Implementation Framework.....	23
5.2 Governance and Organization Structure	25
5.3 Plan Implementation Matrix	29

CHAPTER SIX RISK AND RISK MANAGEMENT

6.1 Introduction.....	30
-----------------------	----

CHAPTER SEVEN RESOURCE MOBILIZATION

7.1 Resource Mobilization	36
7.2 Budgetary Requirements.....	36

7.3 Sources of Revenue	37
------------------------------	----

CHAPTER 8 MONITORING, EVALUATION, REPORTING AND LEARNING

8.1 Introduction	38
8.2 Strategies for Monitoring and Evaluation (M & E)	38
8.2.1 Sustainability Balanced Scorecard (SBSC)	38
8.2.2 Plan Implementation Champion/Team	39
8.2.3 Cascading the Plan	39
8.2.4 Committee and Individual Annual Work Plans	40
8.2.5 Periodic Meetings	40
8.2.6 Conclusion.....	40

Annexes	41
---------------	----

Annex 1: Implementation (Action Plan) Matrices	42
--	----

Acknowledgement

The St. Gabriel Catholic Church Thome Self Help Group Strategic Plan 2026–2030 is the product of a deliberate, consultative, and reflective process aimed at positioning the Group for sustainable growth, institutional strengthening, and enhanced service to its members.

The Management Committee sincerely acknowledges the invaluable contributions of our members, leadership, and stakeholders who participated in the development of this Plan. Their insights and experiences were fundamental in shaping its strategic direction and priorities.

Special appreciation is extended to:

- The Director of Caritas Nairobi, Fr. Peter Kiaire, and the greater Caritas Nairobi leadership for their strategic feedback and guidance.
- Our Patron and Father-in-Charge, Fr. Martin Njihia, for his spiritual leadership, his time as a key resource person, and his unwavering support.
- The Management Committee—Sam Wainaina, Raphael Kabando, Josephine Njau, Elizabeth Thiaka, Suleiman Chege, Naomi Mungai, and Mary Njoroge—for their strategic oversight and dedication throughout the planning process.
- Our former chairpersons and vice chairpersons, Prof Francis Kibera, Graham Waliaula, Joseph Ruhiu, and Mrs. Margaret Nyagah, for sharing their wisdom and institutional memory.
- Our consultants, Professor Francis Kibera and Fredrick Njoroge of Promin Consultants, for their professional facilitation and for guiding us to develop a practical, results-oriented Plan.
- We also express our gratitude to the Moderator of the St. Gabriel Pastoral Council, Mr. Peter Wairegi, and all Council members for providing a supportive environment and for their material and moral support.

The successful implementation of this Strategic Plan hinges on our continued collaboration, discipline, and shared commitment. We are confident that by working together, we will translate this strategy into meaningful action and lasting impact for the benefit of all members, both present and future.

Sam Wainaina

Chairman

St. Gabriel Catholic Church Thome Self Help Group

Abbreviations and Acronyms

ADO	Archdiocesan Development Office of Nairobi
AGM	Annual General Meeting
AML	Anti-Money Laundering
BETA	Bottom-Up Economic Transformation Agenda
BSC	Balanced Scorecard
CBSDC	Capacity Building, Strategy and Development Committee
CTF	Counter-Terrorism Financing
FSS	Financial Services Sector
ICT	Information and Communication Technology
KES	Kenya Shilling
KPI	Key Performance Indicator
M&E	Monitoring and Evaluation
MERL	Monitoring, Evaluation, Reporting and Learning
MTP	Medium-Term Plan
NPL	Non-Performing Loan
SBSC	Sustainability Balanced Scorecard
SEEP	Socio-Economic Empowerment Programme
SHG	Self Help Group
SHP	Self-Help Programme
SRF	Self-Regulatory Framework
SWOT	Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats
TNA	Training Needs Assessment

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The St. Gabriel Catholic Church Thome Self-Help Group (SHG) Strategic Plan 2026–2030 provides a clear and a structured roadmap for strengthening the Group’s institutional capacity, financial sustainability, governance, and socio-economic impact over the next five years. The Plan is anchored in Christian values of integrity, accountability, inclusivity, and stewardship, and aligns with the mission and oversight framework of Caritas Nairobi, Kenya Vision 2030, the Medium-Term Plans, and the Bottom-Up Economic Transformation Agenda. It responds to emerging economic realities, regulatory expectations, and the evolving needs of members within the parish and surrounding community.

The development of the Strategic Plan followed a comprehensive review of the SHG past performance, operating environment, stakeholder expectations, and institutional capacity. Between 2021 and 2025, the SHG recorded steady growth in membership, share capital, and investment income, demonstrating strong member confidence and financial discipline. Share capital grew to over KES 87 million, while investment income and loan issuance showed positive trends. However, the review also revealed critical strategic challenges that must be addressed to ensure long-term sustainability. These include low youth participation and an ageing membership base, relatively low loan uptake despite growing capital, governance and compliance gaps, limited digital infrastructure, overreliance on traditional revenue streams, and the need to enhance member value and satisfaction in a competitive financial services environment.

The Strategic Plan articulates a forward-looking vision of becoming a leading Catholic-based financial service provider committed to inclusive, ethical, and innovative socio-economic empowerment. This vision is operationalized through a mission focused on empowering members through savings mobilization, provision of affordable credit, financial literacy, and value-based service delivery supported by modern technology. The Plan is guided by core values that emphasize integrity and transparency in all undertakings, professionalism and honest communication, teamwork and mutual support, innovation and openness to new approaches, inclusivity in participation and benefit sharing, accountability to God, the Church, and its members, and faithful stewardship of resources entrusted to the Group.

The Strategic Plan is structured around six interrelated strategic objectives. The first objective focuses on growing membership by 20 percent annually in 2026 and 2027 and by 10 percent annually thereafter, from a baseline of 376 members. This will be achieved through targeted recruitment within and beyond the Parish, enhanced visibility during church activities, structured referral programmes, youth-focused engagement initiatives, and strengthened member retention mechanisms.

The second objective aims to grow share capital by an average of 25 percent annually through member education on savings, incentives for referrals, and sustained engagement on the long-term value of collective investment.

The third objective seeks to increase loan uptake by 6 percent annually by reviewing and streamlining loan processes, reducing turnaround times, strengthening guarantorship arrangements through group-based mechanisms, expanding financial literacy on loan products, and introducing loan uptake campaigns and loyalty rewards for consistent borrowers.

The fourth objective addresses governance, risk management, and human resource capacity by transitioning from a management committee-centric model to a governance-driven board structure, strengthening audit, risk, and compliance functions, enhancing leadership capacity, and institutionalizing mentorship, succession planning, and performance management systems.

The fifth objective focuses on ICT and digital transformation to improve management decision-making and service delivery. Planned interventions include digitization of records and reporting systems, development and operationalization of an SHG website, adoption of basic data analytics and research based planning, performance monitoring, and targeted ICT training for leaders, staff, and members. The sixth objective promotes environmental sustainability and positive social impact through the adoption of green practices, expansion of corporate social investment activities, collaboration with stakeholders on environmental initiatives, and the introduction of youth-led volunteer programmes that align faith-based values with community development.

Implementation of the Strategic Plan will be guided by a structured framework informed by the McKinsey 7S Model, ensuring alignment between strategy, organizational structure, systems, shared values, skills, staff, and leadership style. Detailed implementation matrices translate strategic objectives into specific activities, timelines, performance indicators, responsibilities, and cost estimates. Annual work plans will cascade strategic priorities to committees and individuals, ensuring ownership, accountability, and effective execution.

Risk management is integrated throughout the Plan, with clear identification of governance, operational, financial, ICT, human resource, compliance, and reputational risks. Mitigation measures include strengthening internal controls, enhancing cybersecurity and data protection, enforcing segregation of duties, conducting regular audits, and fostering a risk-aware culture supported by continuous training and leadership oversight.

The total projected cost of implementing the Strategic Plan over the five-year period is approximately KES 28.37 million. Projected gross revenues over the same period

amount to about KES 84.91 million, derived primarily from loan interest, investment income, and other supplementary sources. This results in a projected cumulative surplus of approximately KES 56.54 million, demonstrating the financial viability and sustainability of the Plan, provided prudent financial management and disciplined implementation are maintained.

Monitoring, evaluation, reporting, and learning will be anchored on a Sustainability Balanced Scorecard (SBSC) that integrates financial performance, member satisfaction, internal processes, learning and growth, and environmental and social impact. Regular reporting, periodic reviews, and feedback mechanisms will support adaptive management, continuous improvement, and accountability to members and stakeholders.

Overall, the Strategic Plan 2026–2030 provides a realistic, coherent, and value-driven framework for positioning the St. Gabriel Catholic Church Thome SHG as a resilient, well-governed, and member-centered institution. Its successful implementation will strengthen financial inclusion, enhance member welfare, promote ethical and innovative service delivery, and reinforce the SHG's contribution to Parish, community, and national development in line with Catholic social teaching.

CHAPTER ONE: INTRODUCTION

1.1 Background

Caritas Internationalis is a global confederation of more than 160 Catholic relief, development, and social service organizations operating in over 200 countries. Founded in Germany in 1897 by Lorenz Werthmann, its original mandate was to advance social welfare for the poor and disadvantaged. The organization assumed its current global structure and name in 1951, when it was endorsed by the Vatican as the official humanitarian and development arm of the Catholic Church. Today, Caritas Internationalis supports vulnerable populations regardless of religion, focusing on humanitarian aid, social justice advocacy, and long-term development programmes.

Caritas Nairobi represents this global network at the regional level in Kenya. Established in 1973 as the Archdiocesan Development Office (ADO) and rebranded as Caritas Nairobi in 2008, serves as the Aid and Development Department of the Catholic Archdiocese of Nairobi. Caritas Nairobi works with communities, church structures, government agencies, and partners to implement programmes in poverty reduction, food security, education, health, youth empowerment, and emergency response. Its work is grounded in Catholic social teaching, particularly the principles of human dignity, economic justice, and solidarity.

The socio-economic empowerment orientation that underpins SHGs within the Archdiocese is deeply rooted in the pastoral and social vision of Cardinal Maurice Michael Otunga, the long-serving Archbishop of Nairobi. Cardinal Otunga championed self-reliance, social justice, and structured lay participation in economic development as integral components of evangelization. His leadership laid the moral and institutional foundation for organized parish-based savings and credit initiatives, which later evolved into structured programmes under Caritas. The emphasis on dignity of work, community solidarity, and disciplined stewardship that characterizes SHGs today reflects this foundational vision.

In January 2024, Fr. Peter Kiarie assumed office as the Director of Caritas Nairobi. In August 2024, Caritas launched the Self-Regulatory Framework (SRF) to guide the Socio-Economic Empowerment Programme (SEEP), marking the 40th anniversary of the Self-Help Programme (SHP) during celebrations held at Our Lady of Fatima, Kiriko, Mang'u, Kiambu County. The anniversary not only celebrated institutional growth but also reaffirmed the enduring legacy of Cardinal Otunga's social doctrine, which continues to shape the Church's development interventions within the Archdiocese.

The Self-Help Programme (SHP) provides a structured financial empowerment model for Christian communities. Its vision is "to be a model financial provider owned by

Christian communities and managed on Christian values of love and charity.” Its mission is “to empower Christian communities by savings mobilization, provision of credit, investment training, and technical support through effective and efficient coordination.” Caritas Nairobi plays the central role of coordinating, supporting, and regulating SHP groups to ensure alignment with this mission.

St. Gabriel Catholic Church Thome Self Help Group (SHG) is one of the SHP-affiliated financial empowerment groups within the Archdiocese. The SHG was founded on 18th December 2011 with 29 members and an initial share capital of KES 23,100. With consistent growth and improved organizational capacity, the Group formally registered with Caritas Nairobi on 21st February 2013 under an Interim Management Committee, which was later confirmed during the first Annual General Meeting on 11th October 2014. The SHG core purpose is to promote savings, provide affordable credit, and enhance the socio-economic wellbeing of parishioners and the wider community.

1.2 Rationale for developing the Plan

The St. Gabriel Catholic Thome SHG was established to strengthen the economic and social empowerment of members through a structured savings and lending model grounded in Christian values of solidarity and mutual support. As the Group approaches the end of its current strategic period (2021-2025), it is necessary to reflect on its progress, emerging opportunities, and new challenges within its operating environment.

Developing a new Strategic Plan will enable the SHG to examine the internal and external environment in which it operates; identify emerging trends, risks, and opportunities affecting service delivery; review its performance, mandate, vision, mission, and values for continued relevance; address strategic issues and institutional gaps identified during the evaluation period; and align its priorities with those of Caritas Nairobi, Caritas Microfinance Bank, and national socio-economic frameworks.

The strategic direction of the SHG remain consistent with the aspirations of its key stakeholders and the wider Caritas family. The formulation of this Strategic Plan is therefore an opportunity to reaffirm the Group’s commitment to serving God and humanity, enhance the welfare of its members, strengthen community resilience, and ensure that the SHG continues to make a positive social and economic impact at parish, diocesan, national, and global levels.

1.3 Organization of the Plan

This Strategic Plan is structured into eight chapters. The opening chapter provides an introduction and background on the Self Help Group, establishing the rationale and importance of developing this strategic plan. Chapter 2 examines Kenya's national development agenda and demonstrates how micro and small scale financial entities contribute to achieving these broader development goals.

Chapter 3 presents a contextual analysis, examining the environment in which the SHG operates. The core strategic elements, including the Vision, Mission, Core Values, Objectives, and Strategies of the SHG are presented in Chapter 4. Chapter 5 outlines the implementation framework and tools necessary for effectively executing the Plan. Chapter 6 discusses the risks and risk management strategies associated with implementing the Plan. Chapter 7 highlights resource mobilization required for implementing the Plan while Chapter 8 details the monitoring, evaluation, reporting and learning (MERL) mechanism that will be used to track progress and measure performance of the Self-Help Group.

CHAPTER TWO: KENYA'S DEVELOPMENT AGENDA

2.1 Introduction

This Chapter outlines Kenya's national development agenda anchored in Vision 2030 and successive Medium-Term Plans (MTPs) and highlights the role of community-based financial systems, particularly formal and informal financial service groups and specifically on Caritas Nairobi-affiliated Self-Help Groups (SHGs), in advancing national socio-economic transformation.

2.2 The National Development Agenda

Kenya Vision 2030 is the country's long-term development blueprint aimed at transforming Kenya into a newly industrialized, middle-income nation offering a high quality of life in a clean, secure environment. Vision 2030 is implemented through a series of five-year Medium-Term Plans (MTPs), with the current plan being MTP IV (2023–2027). The blueprint is anchored on three pillars: economic, social and political pillars.



An image of the Kenya Vision 2030 Blueprint

The Economic Pillar aims to achieve an average economic growth rate of 10% per annum and to sustain the same till 2030 in order to generate more resources to meet the national development goals. The Social Pillar seeks to create and build a just and cohesive society that enjoys equitable social development in a clean and secure environment while the Political Pillar aims at realizing an issue-based, people-centered, result-oriented and accountable democratic system.

Vision 2030 recognizes the Financial Services Sector (FSS) as critical for resource mobilization and economic growth. Priority focus areas include deepening financial markets; enhancing inclusion, efficiency and stability; expanding electronic and digital payments; strengthening pension, insurance, and investment systems; and integrating regional financial markets.

2.3 Informal and Non-Formal Financial Service Groups

Majority of Kenyans rely on informal savings groups such as chamas or self-help groups. These groups promote savings discipline; provide social support; enable pooled investment; offer flexible and proximity-based financial services. Kenya has an estimated 300,000 chamas controlling over KES 300 billion in assets, demonstrating the scale of informal finance. Their popularity across genders and age groups highlights their role in addressing financial exclusion and building community resilience.

2.4 Caritas Nairobi and SHGs role in the National Development Agenda

Caritas Nairobi plays a strategic role in Kenya's development agenda. It is a coordinating, regulatory, and trust fund management institution for community-based financial empowerment Groups within the Archdiocese of Nairobi.



Caritas Nairobi mobilizes and safeguards community resources through structured financial empowerment programmes; offers trust and fiduciary oversight for Self-Help Groups (SHGs), ensuring transparency, accountability, and alignment with Church social teaching; provides capacity-building, training, and governance

frameworks that strengthen Group performance and financial stewardship; and manages and guides the Self-Regulatory Framework (SRF) introduced in 2024 to standardize operations, enhance risk management, and promote best practices among SHGs. Caritas Nairobi, as a trust fund, provides the institutional backbone that safeguards member contributions, strengthens financial discipline, and builds confidence across SHGs.

SHGs, under Caritas Nairobi's coordination, directly contribute to household income growth; grassroots enterprise development; youth and women empowerment; financial inclusion enhancement; and investment mobilization for local development initiatives. They operate as accessible, community-owned financial vehicles that complement the roles of other microfinance institutions especially for low-income households and parish-based communities.

CHAPTER THREE: SITUATION ANALYSIS

The need to develop a roadmap for the SHG required a critical analysis of the past performance, as well as the key factors, both internal and external, that influence its success in achieving its Mission and goals during the Plan period. This was accomplished through an assessment of both the internal and external operating environments.

3.1 Review of Past Performance

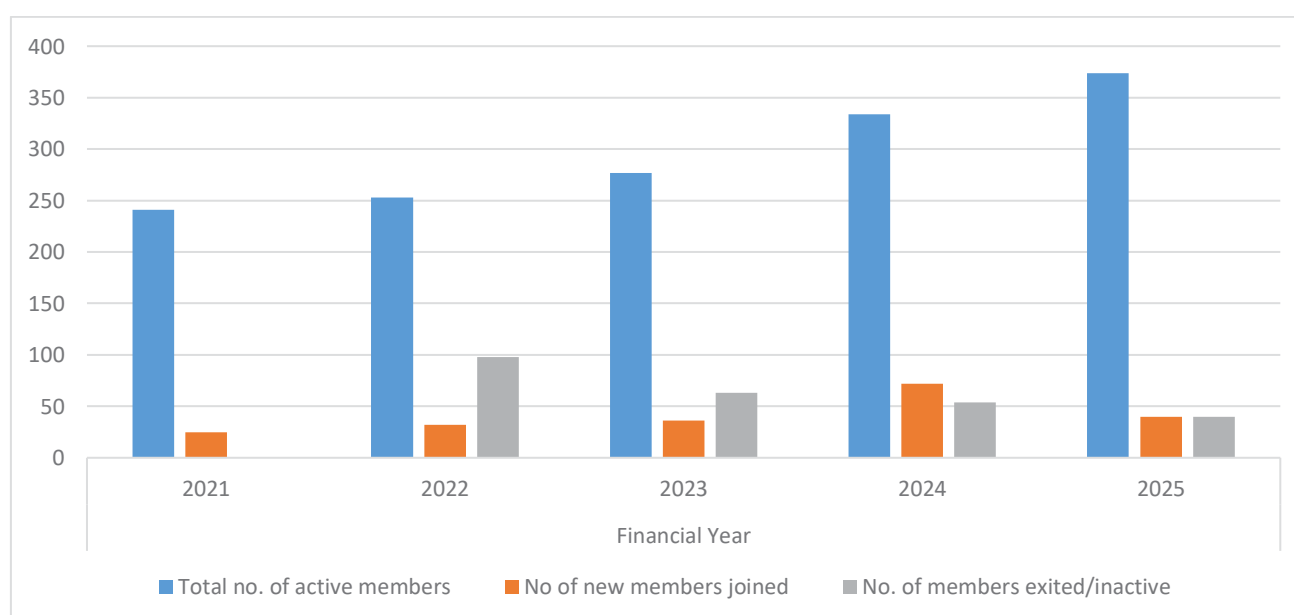
□ Membership

Table 3.1 and Figure 3.1 present membership data from 2021-2025.

Table 3.1: SHG Membership 2021 – 2025

Description	Financial Year				
	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Total no. of active members	241	253	277	334	376
No of new members joined	25	32	36	72	40
No. of members exited/inactive	-	98	63	54	40

Figure 3.1: SHG membership trends from 2021 – 2025



In the 2021-2025 Strategic Plan membership grew from 241 to 376 active members. The number of new members increased from 25 in 2021 to 40 in 2025. The number of members exiting or becoming inactive has decreased from 98 in 2021 to 40 in 2025. This is a favourable trend.

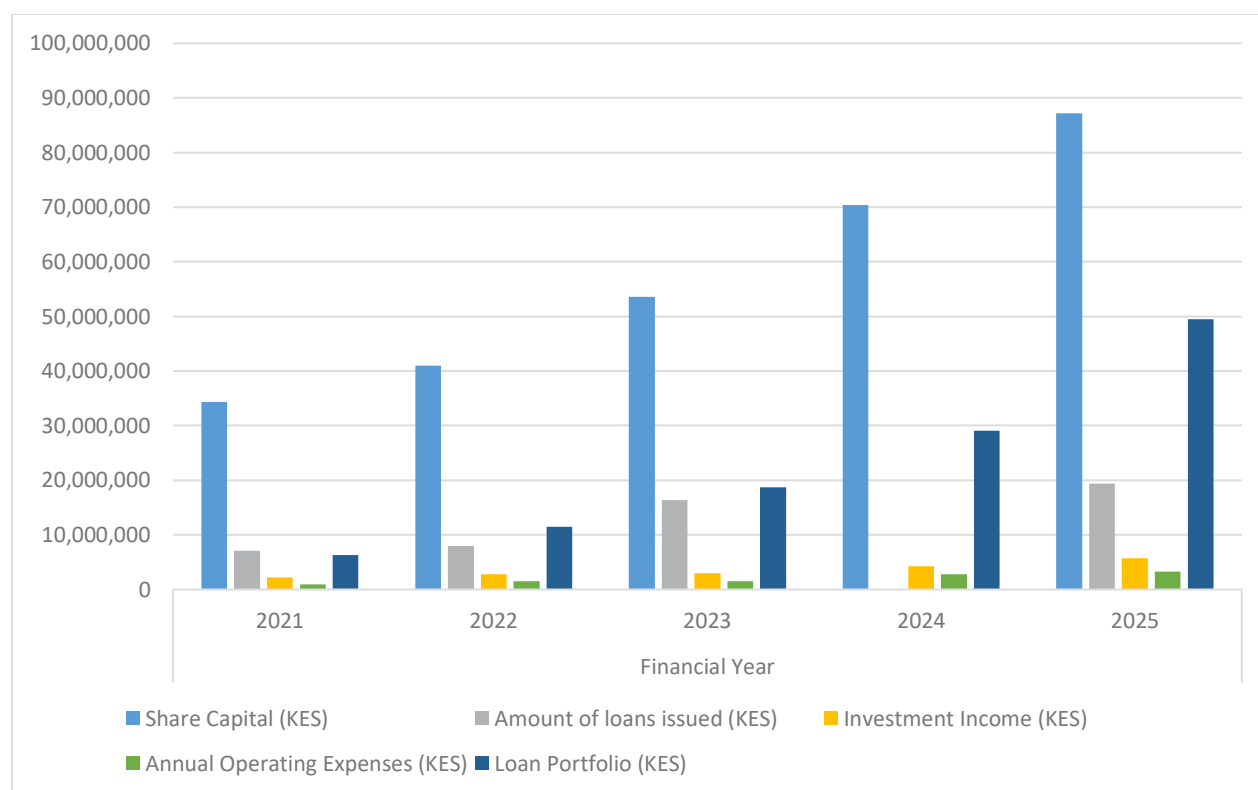
□ **Financial Performance Statistics**

Table 3.2 and Figure 3.2 below show the trend in the last five years.

Table 3.2: Financial Performance Statistics (KES)

Item Description	Financial Year				
	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025
Share Capital (KES)	34,349,147	41,018,001	53,761,500	70,404,565	87,228,750
Amount of loans issued (KES)	7,130,000	7,928,522	16,397,126	23,170,780	19,381,000
Investment Income (KES)	2,242,415	2,744,882	3,011,537	4,286,153	5,683,429
Annual Operating Expenses (KES)	960,515	1,561,413	1,467,050	2,755,863	3,236,994
Loan Portfolio (KES)	6,302,434	11,438,361	18,742,738	29,114,422	49,515,000

Figure 3.2: Financial Performance Statistics (KES)



The results in Table 3.2 and Figure 3.2 show that SHG share capital grew by 153.9% from KES 34.3 million in 2021 to KES 87.2 million in 2025. This means share capital growth remains a key organizational strength. Similarly, the amount of loans issued grew from KES 7.1million to KES 19.4 million (171.8%) from 2021 to 2025 respectively. Investment income grew from KES 2.2 million in 2021 to KES 5.7 million in 2025 representing a 153.5% increase.

Annual operating expenses increased from KES 960,515 in 2021 to KES 3,236,994 in 2025, representing cumulative growth of 237.0%. The year-on-year movements were 2022: +62.6%; 2023: -6.0%; 2024: +87.9%; and 2025: +17.5%

Expense growth has outpaced income growth, creating emerging cost pressure. The expense-to-investment-income ratio fluctuated between 42.8% and 64.3%, indicating volatility in cost efficiency. While SHG remains income-positive, strengthened budgetary discipline and cost containment measures will be necessary to protect future surpluses. There is therefore need to strengthen financial control systems and more realistic budget forecasting in future planning cycles.

SHG's outstanding loan portfolio expanded significantly from KES 6,302,434 in 2021 to KES 49,515,000 in 2025, representing cumulative growth of 685.7% over the five-year period. The year-on-year growth rates were as follows, 2022: +81.5%; 2023: +63.9%; 2024: +55.3%; and 2025: +70.1%.

The re-acceleration in 2025 indicates sustained demand for credit facilities. Notably, the outstanding portfolio in 2025 (KES 49.5 million) significantly exceeds the new loans issued during the year (KES 19.38 million), suggesting strong loan retention, larger average loan sizes, or extended repayment cycles. While this reflects portfolio maturity and strong member engagement, it also increases exposure to credit concentration risk. A detailed portfolio quality assessment (including delinquency ratios and provisioning adequacy) is recommended to ensure growth remains healthy and sustainable.

3.2 Internal Environment Analysis

The purpose of internal analysis was to identify the SHG assets, resources, and skills. This analysis resulted in identifying key strengths and weaknesses. Strengths were viewed as aspects of the SHG operations that represent activities that the SHG does very well and/or resources (assets) that it controls. On their part weaknesses (constraints) were identified as what the SHG does not do well and/or resources (assets) that it lacks. The analysis was done in the areas of:

☐ **Facilities, equipment and ICT**

The SHG is situated at St. Gabriel Catholic Church grounds along the Northern Bypass. It operates from a permanent structure from where the Group conducts its business with some furniture, a filing cabinet and adequate stationery. The SHG premises are adequately supplied with electricity and, in the event of a power outage, the Group utilizes the Church generator to ensure continuity of operations. The SHG does not have adequate transport facilities thus hampering service delivery. The Group has its own desktop, printer and modem. The Group has utilized software/systems to carry out financial transactions empowered by the Caritas Microfinance bank. However, the Group needs to put in place additional Management Information Systems such as website, procurement, accounting and human resource systems among others.

☐ **Human resources (People)**

Human resources comprise staff, management committee and volunteers. The Group has benefitted from its strategic location in the following ways:

Benefit from Thome and Garden Estates: Members of St. Gabriel Catholic Church, from which the Self Help Group draws its support, reside in Thome and Garden Estates which are made up of an upper middle class community. A typical resident in this area will be a property owner, well educated, already established in Professions, Businesses, Civil Service and with a high average income. The spirit of working together is well ingrained. The same spirit has enabled the Catholic

Faithful to put up a church whose membership include many residents living within the environs but sharing the same spirit.

Benefit from Voluntary Service: The Group has continued to benefit from free voluntary service in many areas including preparation of this Strategic Plan, development of Group By-laws and other capacity building activities. There is need for SHG management to explore ways to enhance and extend this Volunteer Service to Youth in Group/Church and Environs.



SHG representatives visiting the Wings of Compassion Children's Home

Benefits from Caritas Nairobi, Provision of Technical Services: Caritas Nairobi has assisted the Group in various ways including capacity building, provision of accountancy and audit services and **Co-Bank+ system**. It also provides the oversight role to the Group.

3.3 External Environment Analysis

The St Gabriel Self Help Group (SHG) operates within a dynamic environment influenced by multiple external forces. Understanding these forces is essential for positioning the SHG strategically for growth, resilience, and service to its members. These include:

Political Factors

The political environment in Kenya significantly shapes the opportunities and risks for Self Help Groups (SHGs). The government actively supports SHGs as part of its poverty reduction and community empowerment strategies; for example, through simplified group registration policies and support under the Ministry of Labour and Social Protection. However, regulatory compliance is crucial. SHGs in Nairobi must register with authorities, such as the Social Protection Directorate, to gain legitimacy and access certain benefits. Political stability in Nairobi County allows

predictable SHG activities, but shifting political priorities or local leadership changes can influence funding or policy support. Faith-based groups such as St. Gabriel Thome SHG often benefits from strong linkage with Church structures and Government programmes which can boost advocacy and resource mobilization.

Economic Factors

SHGs operate within Nairobi's dynamic economic ecosystem. Many members rely on SHGs for microfinance services, including savings accumulation and access to credit, which typical banks may not provide affordably. In 2024, 84.8% of Kenyan adults had access to formal financial services, and 68.1% were savers; yet, only 64% had taken credit from formal sources such as banks, mobile money credit, or formal lenders thereby highlighting gaps addressed by SHGs¹. For example, SHGs enable small-scale entrepreneurs and informal traders near Thome and its environs to secure low-interest loans to start or expand businesses in contrast to digital lending, where mobile money borrowing by adults in Kenya reached approximately 32% in 2024².

The Kenyan government's interest rate caps have increased SHGs' appeal as alternative financial service providers. This occurs in a context where Central Bank of Kenya policy rates were around 13% in 2024, making formal credit relatively costly for small businesses³. SHGs provide a cushion against economic shocks by pooling resources, but the sustainability of their financial offerings depends on strong internal management and external support. Estimates suggest there are over 300,000 Chamas in Kenya pooling approximately KES 300 billion (~US\$3.4 billion) in community assets an indicator of the scale of group finance within the economy⁴.

Social-Cultural Factors

SHG operates in Nairobi's socially diverse context, where social-cultural dynamics can influence group cohesion and participation. Nairobi's communities include various ethnic groups, requiring SHG to foster inclusivity and respect cultural differences to maintain unity and collective action. For example, successful SHGs often engage members in joint activities beyond finance, such as social support networks, health education, and youth mentorship, thus strengthening social capital. Faith also plays a strong motivating role, with Church values reinforcing ethical group operations and member discipline. Social cohesion enhances SHG participation but risks exist if any Group's practices exclude certain members or fail to adapt to evolving community needs, such as growing youth involvement or gender

¹ https://www.statskenya.co.ke/public/at-stats-kenya/about/financial-inclusion-and-exclusion-in-kenya-access-to-financial-services-by-county/117/?utm_source

² https://eastleighvoice.co.ke/business/183771/kenya-leads-in-mobile-money-borrowing-as-sub-saharan-africa-leans-on-informal-loans---world-bank-report?utm_source

³ https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S104523542500036X?utm_source

⁴ https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Chama_%28investment%29?utm_source

equality expectations. In Kenya, community financial groups like chamas often have memberships ranging from 11–30+ members, with up to 49.3% of SHGs cited as having 11–19 members, underscoring their role as micro-community institutions⁵.

Technological Factors

Technology, especially mobile finance (mobile money platforms like M-Pesa), has revolutionized SHG operations in Nairobi. Members of St. Gabriel SHG can use mobile phones for savings deposits, loan repayments, and financial record-keeping, drastically reducing transaction costs and improving transparency. M-Pesa and other mobile wallets are used by over 90% of Kenyans, making Kenya one of the world's highest mobile money adoption markets⁶.

Fintech innovations, such as digital lending platforms, offer new credit sources and more tailored financial products to SHG. However, challenges include members' varying digital literacy levels and internet access disparities, which can limit technological benefits for some. Only about 42% of Kenyans are considered financially literate, highlighting the need for targeted training⁷.

Continued investment in ICT training and infrastructure will be critical for maximizing technology adoption. Emerging technologies like artificial intelligence and block chain could also provide future opportunities for enhancing SHG governance and security.

Ecological Factors

Environmental sustainability is increasingly relevant for Nairobi SHGs. Urban environmental challenges such as waste management, flooding, and air pollution affect members' quality of life and economic activities. SHGs have begun integrating environmental adaptation practices into their community activities. For instance, some SHGs participate in tree planting initiatives, water conservation projects, and climate education campaigns to boost resilience against climate change impacts. Evidence from rural Kenya shows that SHGs facilitate transitioning from firewood to cleaner energy sources, reducing deforestation. For urban SHGs like St. Gabriel Thome SHG, supporting greener entrepreneurship and sustainable practices aligns with growing environmental awareness among members and the broader community.

Legal Factors

In August 2024, Caritas Nairobi launched a Self-Regulatory Framework (SRF) for its Socio-Economic Empowerment Program (SEEP), which establishes the governing

⁵ https://ir-library.ku.ac.ke/server/api/core/bitstreams/9df5243b-665f-4109-9557-09921b0632e9/content?utm_source

⁶ https://www.geopoll.com/blog/kenyas-financial-landscape-report/?utm_source=chatgpt.com&utm_source

⁷ https://www.statskenya.co.ke/public/at-stats-kenya/about/financial-inclusion-and-exclusion-in-kenya-access-to-financial-services-by-county/117/?utm_source

and operational standards for all affiliated SHGs, including governance, risk management, and accountability. This complements the mandatory registration with the Ministry of Gender, Children and Social Development, which continues to provide the SHG with legal standing to open bank accounts, own assets, and enter into formal contracts.

SHGs must in addition adhere to broader laws that affect their operations and relationships with financial institutions like Caritas Microfinance Bank. The Data Protection Act of 2019 is particularly critical, as it governs the handling of members' financial and personal information, which is a major consideration for SHGs and their banking partners. Additionally, the Draft Community Groups Registration Regulations, 2025, also aims to formalize the operations of community groups by providing rules for their registration, leadership, and compliance, with an emphasis on promoting transparency and accountability through proper record-keeping and financial reporting. Lastly, as SHGs manage collective finances, they remain subject to anti-money laundering (AML) and counter-terrorism financing (CTF) regulations, necessitating ongoing due diligence. Adherence to these current and future legal and regulatory requirements is essential for an SHG's long-term sustainability and credibility within the Caritas Nairobi ecosystem.

3.4 Stakeholder Analysis

In order for SHG to fulfill its mandate it is critical that it continually engages with a wide range of stakeholders. A stakeholder is any person, group, or organization that can place a claim on SHG resources, attention or output or is affected by its output. Stakeholder analysis is the review and consideration of the impact stakeholders have on the operations of SHG. A list of major stakeholders and their expectations from SHG are depicted in Table 3.3.

Table 3.3: SHG major Stakeholders and their Expectations

Stakeholder	What they expect from SHG?	What SHG expects from stakeholders	Level of Influence (High, Medium or Low)
Members	• Effective and efficient service delivery • High return on their contributions/investments • Quick processing of loan applications	• Timely payment of contributions • Timely repayment of loans • Provision of voluntary service • Operating within the by-laws and general guidelines • Active participation in the affairs of the SHG	High
SHG leaders, Managers and Staff	• Stable and progressive SHG • Competitive terms and conditions of service • Transparency and Accountability • Efficiency and effectiveness in service delivery	• Commitment and peak performance • Portrayal of the positive image of the SHG • Adherence to rules and regulations of the SHG	High
St. Gabriel Catholic Church, Ruaraka Parish and Archdiocese of Nairobi	• Run the affairs of SHG effectively and efficiently for the benefit of the members	• Providing conducive operating environment	High
Caritas Nairobi	• Operate within the guidelines and procedures • Conduct SHG business ethically	• Provide requisite services according to agreed timelines • Provide strategic direction	High

Stakeholder	What they expect from SHG?	What SHG expects from stakeholders	Level of Influence (High, Medium or Low)
Suppliers	• To conduct business professionally • Prompt settlement of invoices	• Prompt supply of quality goods and services • Ethical conduct in their operations	Low
Local Communities	• Understanding their needs and expectations. • Initiation of sustainable projects. • Involvement of community leaders in decision making and service delivery	• Local support for SHG activities	Medium
National and County Governments	• Respect for rule of law	• Provision of safe and secure environment	Medium
General public	• Development of effective and efficient products and services	• Goodwill and support	Low

The stakeholders identified here above are critical to the success of SHG. Stakeholder analysis will be a continuous exercise as needs and wants are dynamic and institutional/stakeholder affiliations change over time. This will ensure cooperation and support in the achievement of SHG mission and realization of its vision.

3.5 The SWOT Analysis

After an analysis of past performance of SHG and its internal and external environments the following strengths, weaknesses, opportunities and threats (SWOT) for the SHG were agreed on (Table 3.4).

Table 3.4: SHG Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats

Strengths	Weaknesses (Constraints)
• Competent, professional and dedicated Management team • Exceptional share capital growth • Strong savings culture and member trust. • Robust investment income. • Healthy reserve accumulation. • Strong governance with Church oversight. • Faith-based culture and community integration. • Effective leadership transitions. • Transparent financial controls and audits. • Goodwill from the Church Leadership and Parishioners • Cross guaranteeing of loans within SHGs in the Archdiocese • Adequate ICT support from CARITAS	• No website or digital presence. • Inadequate digital financial services. • Inadequate staffing. • Aging membership and high exits. • Narrow product range • Low loan uptake. • Relatively small membership • Inadequate staff competency • Inadequate succession planning
Opportunities	Threats
• Untapped non-Catholic market. • Growing and educated urban youth population • Availability of technological solutions. • Kenya Vision 2030 and BETA • Caritas network. • Availability of effective and efficient communication infrastructure • Goodwill towards the Church from the surrounding community • Growing economic empowerment for the surrounding community • Favorable financial policy and legal frameworks	• Potential political instability • Competition from informal savings groups (chamas), SACCOs among others. • Caritas policy constraints. • Negative economic downturn and high living costs. • Member exits and youth disengagement. • Cybersecurity and digital divide risks.

This SWOT analysis reveals that while SHG has very good financial strengths and governance foundations, it faces critical challenges in technology adoption, product innovation, and demographic engagement that must be addressed urgently in the 2026-2030 strategic plan to ensure long-term sustainability and competitiveness.

3.6 Strategic Issues/Priority Areas

A strategic issue also known as a critical success factor is anything that must be addressed if the SHG is to succeed. It is therefore a fundamental challenge affecting our mandate, mission, programmes, clients or users, financing, or management. After an extensive analysis and review of the current and projected operating environments, the strategic issues (priority areas) to be addressed in the current plan cycle are:

(i) Low youth engagement and ageing membership

- Major demographic risk: A majority of Kenya's population is under 35 years yet SHG youth membership is minimal.
- Overreliance on older members threatens long-term sustainability of SHG.

(ii) Loan uptake challenges and narrow product portfolio

- Low loan uptake despite growing share capital.
- Guarantor limitations and lack of product flexibility.

(iii) Digital infrastructure gaps

- No website, minimal ICT integration, manual processes.
- Youth and modern users expect digital self-service.

(iv) Governance and compliance weaknesses

- Need for transition to board-led governance.
- Audit, risk, and compliance capacities need to be enhanced.
- Caritas statutory deductions issues pose reputational risk.

(v) Member value and satisfaction

- Low dividends relative to competitors leading to membership exit.
- Members inadequately trained on savings, loans, and investment products.

(vi) Revenue concentration and limited diversification

- Heavy dependence on member share capital.
- Restricted investment options under current Caritas rules.

The issues outlined here above constitute the key drivers for the formulation of SHG strategic direction framework presented in the next Chapter.

CHAPTER FOUR: STRATEGIC DIRECTION

4.1 Introduction

The strategic direction comprises vision, mission, values, objectives and corresponding strategies.



4.2 Vision Statement

Vision is a common way of imagining the intended future. A good vision is something that people can visualize; can almost taste and that affects them at an operational level. It is an inspiring view of the preferred future. A vision is therefore a guiding image of success formed in terms of contribution to society. The features of an effective vision statement include clarity and lack of ambiguity; vivid and clear picture; description of a bright future; memorable and engaging wording; and realistic aspirations. Using these criteria, the SHG has agreed that our vision is **“To be a leading Christian based financial service provider committed to promoting inclusive, ethical, and innovative socio-economic empowerment.”**



4.3 Mission Statement

A mission is a concise statement of the basic purpose and role of our Self-Help Group. It specifies the functions (activities) and purpose of the SHG. Our mission is **“To empower members through savings mobilization, provision of affordable credit, financial literacy, and value-based service delivery supported by modern technology.”**



4.4 Value Statement

Values describe the standards that govern the operations of the SHG and its relationships with the members, staff, suppliers, community, and other stakeholders. Values articulate principles which guide actions and ethical behaviour. Our values are a way of expressing how we do things. We shall therefore be guided by the following core values:

- **Integrity:** We will ensure that accountability and transparency prevail in all our undertakings. (Proverbs 10:9)
- **Professionalism:** We believe in honest communication, absolute openness, and transparent and open sharing of information and ideas. (Ephesians 4:25)
- **Teamwork:** Our members realize the need to continue supporting and encouraging each other in all the SHG activities. We will continue to complement each other's effort and build trust in each other. (Ecclesiastes 4:9)
- **Innovation:** We uphold a commitment to innovation in our work and the work of our cooperators/collaborators. (Isaiah 43:19).
- **Accountability:** We are answerable to God, the Church, and fellow members for the resources entrusted to the Group. Leaders and members are expected to act with honesty, transparency, and integrity in financial management, decision-making, and service delivery. (Luke 16:10).
- **Inclusivity:** We will ensure that everyone has a voice, participates in decision-making, and benefits fairly from SHG activities. (Galatians 3:28).
- **Christian Stewardship:** We will use financial contributions, skills, and opportunities wisely for the common good, supporting members in need, and contributing to the mission of the Church and society. (1 Peter 4:10).

4.5 Rallying Call (Motto)

Save Regularly, Borrow Wisely, Pay Promptly.

4.6 Performance Objectives and Strategies

Performance objectives are long range results needed to accomplish the SHG's Mission. They represent answer to the question "Where do we want to go?" Good objectives must state what, how much, and by when something is to be accomplished. In summary, good objectives must be specific, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time bound (SMART). The objectives reflect performance lessons, market realities, member expectations, and institutional reforms.

Objective 1: Increase membership by 20% in 2026 and 2027 and by 10% thereafter (Baseline = 376 members)

Strategies:

- 1.1 Enhance membership recruitment drive within St. Gabriel Catholic Church
- 1.2 Attract membership from Catholics and Non-Catholics from the environs of St. Gabriel Catholic Church
- 1.3 Develop and implement member retention programmes

Objective 2: Grow share capital by 25% annually (Baseline = KES 87 million)

Strategies:

- 2.1 Develop and implement reward system for referrals for the youth
- 2.2 Maintain a minimum annual share capital growth of 25%
- 2.3 Educate members on the value of saving

Objective 3: Increase loan uptake by 6% annually

Strategies:

- 3.1 Review and streamline loan processes, reducing turnaround time
- 3.2 Strengthen guarantor mobilization through Group guarantorship clusters (cells)
- 3.3 Expand member education on available loan products
- 3.4 Introduce loan uptake campaigns and loyalty rewards

Objective 4: Enhance governance, risk management and human resource capacity

Strategies:

- 4.1 Review existing governance systems
- 4.2 Transit from Management Committee to governance driven Board Structure
- 4.3 Strengthen the Group's leadership capacity
- 4.4 Develop and implement a mentorship and succession planning framework
- 4.5 Enhance performance management systems (PMS)

Objective 5: Enhance application of ICT in management decision making and service delivery

Strategies:

- 5.1 Develop and operationalize the SHG website
- 5.2 Digitize operations: records, reporting, communication
- 5.3 Adopt data analytics and research based planning and decision-making
- 5.4 Conduct ICT training for staff, management, and members

Objective 6: Promote environmental sustainability and positive social impact

Strategies:

- 6.1 Institutionalize green practices
- 6.2 Expand annual Corporate Social Investment (CSI) activities

- 6.3 Collaborate with stakeholders on environmental projects
- 6.4 Develop youth-led environmental volunteer programmes

Implementation of the objectives and strategies outlined above will enable the SHG to address the critical issues identified in this Plan.

CHAPTER FIVE: PLAN IMPLEMENTATION

5.1 The Implementation Framework

The McKinsey 7S Framework is a holistic organizational development tool that examines seven interconnected elements essential for effective strategy implementation. For St Gabriel Catholic Church Thome Self-Help Group (SHG), this framework provides a comprehensive approach to ensuring that all organizational components align to achieve the Group's mission and strategic objectives. The 7S with regard to SHG strategic plan implementation are discussed here below:

Strategy: Strategy refers to the plan to achieve SHG goals. The strategic plan is formally presented, discussed, and approved, with minutes recorded and shared. It includes explicit, measurable, achievable, relevant, and time-bound (SMART) goals.

Structure: Structure refers to the way SHG is organized and how it is structured to support its strategy. In order to maintain a simple, non-bureaucratic structure, SHG's governance should be based on its constitution, with a clear and democratic election process for officials. The structure details specific roles and responsibilities to ensure accountability.

Systems: Systems refer to the day-to-day processes and procedures that staff use to get work done. The systems of St Gabriel SHG prioritize transparency and efficiency. This requires robust record-keeping for financial transactions, including savings, loans, and expenses, which is a key recommendation for SHG sustainability. The SHG utilizes a systematic, manual, or digital bookkeeping system that is easily understood by all members. Regular, scheduled audits are essential to ensure financial probity, protect members' funds, and fulfill reporting requirements to Caritas Nairobi under the new Self-Regulatory Framework. The system includes a clear and accessible process for members to apply for, receive, and repay loans, as well as a well-defined dispute resolution process.

Shared Values: These are core values and beliefs that are the foundation of the SHG culture. As a Catholic SHG, the shared values reference the teachings of the Church, such as social justice, solidarity, subsidiarity, and stewardship. These values are the foundation of the Group's social capital, fostering a culture of trust and collective responsibility. They translate into practical actions like compassionate debt collection, peer support during hardships, and equitable distribution of benefits. These core values, rooted in Catholic social teachings and reinforced by the Parish Priest's guidance, create a unique identity that strengthens the Group's resilience, reduces the risk of loan defaults, and ensures its purpose extends beyond mere financial transactions to include community building and spiritual growth.

Skills: These refer to skills and capabilities of staff. For SHG, skills development is crucial for both Group management and members' individual economic empowerment. Training focusses on practical competencies, such as financial literacy (budgeting, savings), entrepreneurship (business planning, marketing), and group governance (record-keeping, conflict resolution). Partnering with Caritas Nairobi and other stakeholders is vital for capacity building and training. Investing in skills for officials ensures they can manage the Group effectively, while empowering members with entrepreneurial skills directly contributes to increased household livelihoods and strengthens the Group's financial foundation.



Members engaged in a financial literacy session during a Self-Help group workshop

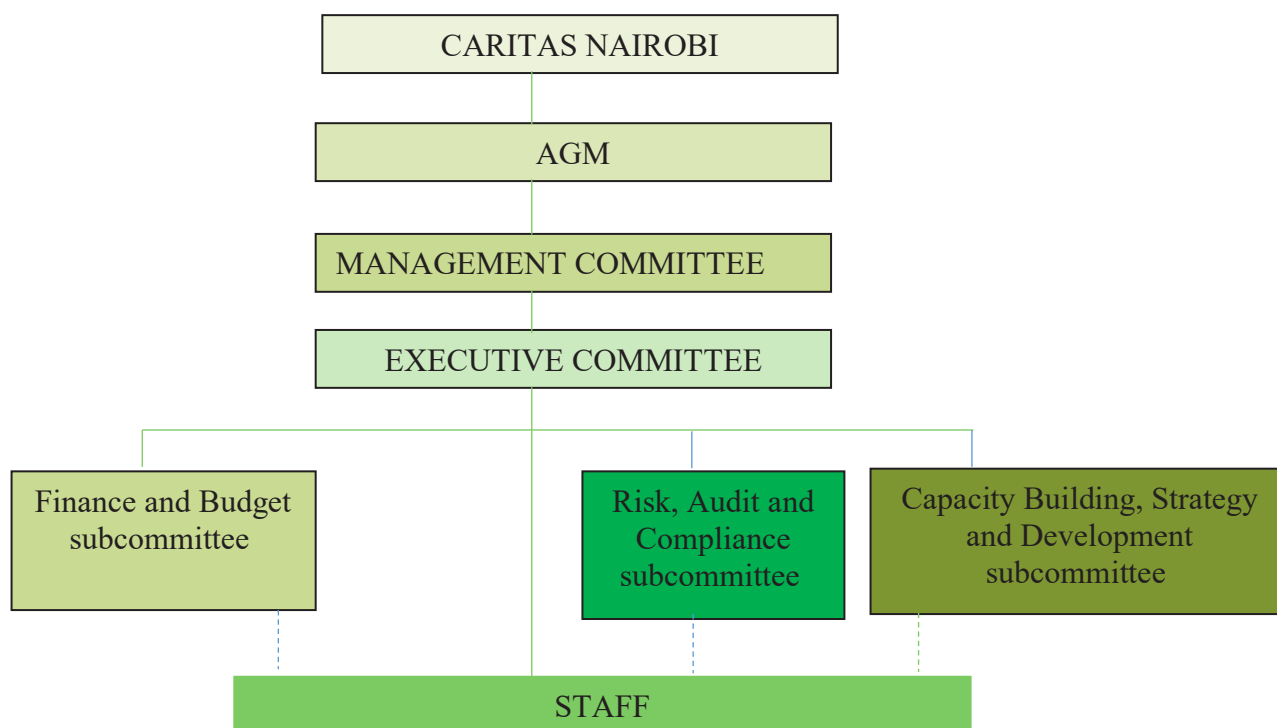
Staff: This refers to human resource and their capabilities. The staffing model for SHG is member-driven and voluntary with elected officials overseeing operations. The strategic plan outlines a clear pathway for professionalization as the Group matures and its financial base strengthens.

Style: Style refers to the leadership style of management and the overall management approach. The leadership style of SHG reflects the servant leadership model where leaders prioritize the needs of the members and the mission over personal gain. This approach, which aligns with Catholic values, promotes an organizational culture of humility, service, and collaboration. Leadership practices include open communication, consensus-based decision-making on key issues, and a supportive, rather than punitive, approach to managing member challenges. This leadership style, combined with SHG shared values, cultivates an environment where members feel respected, heard, and motivated to actively contribute to the Group's success.

5.2 Governance and Organization Structure

The appropriateness of an organizational structure is judged according to how well it aids in the achievement of organizational objectives and how it affects the behavior of the individuals in the SHG. The structure that St. Gabriel Catholic Church SHG is committed to is depicted in Figure 5.1.

Figure 5.1: The St Gabriel Catholic Church Thome SHG Management Structure



The SHG organogram flows seamlessly from Caritas Nairobi to give the SHG legitimacy. It depicts relationships and how the Management Committee delegates its authority to committees and staff. At the end of every year, Management Committee presents a management report to its members through an annual general meeting (AGM) detailing the SHG's performance, audited report, and budget. The AGM also confers authority to the Management Committee in accordance to the members of the SHG and Caritas of Nairobi.

Management Committee

The Management Committee is the Manager and Administrator of the SHG and is responsible for managing the affairs of the Group in accordance with the Caritas Nairobi Self Help Programme Governance Manual. It derives its authority from the AGM and is accountable to the members of the SHG in achieving the purposes set forth in the self-help programme guidelines and by laws on behalf of the members.

Collective Roles and Responsibilities of Management

- a) Offering strategic direction, governance and leadership to the SHG, consistent with the purpose expressed by the members
- b) Recruiting and orienting new staff
- c) Monitoring staff performance
- d) Reviewing the group's annual plan to ensure it is aligned to the mission and vision
- e) Ensure adequate resources are identified and allocated to support the Management Committee and organizational priorities
- f) Ensure that resources are used in a cost-effective manner to support the group's strategic plan and annual plans and within the parameters of the approved budget
- g) Determine, monitor and strengthen the organization's public image and standing
- h) Ensure legal and ethical integrity and maintain accountability
- i) Exercise a fiduciary responsibility to the group and its resources
- j) Ensure that true and accurate records of the groups' money, its properties, capital reserves, liabilities, income and expenses are kept
- k) Present before the annual general meeting financial statements and reports together with the proposal for the disposal of net surplus (if any) and Caritas Nairobi's comments on such proposals
- l) Immediately inform Caritas Nairobi of any alternative proposal from the Annual General Meeting for disposing of surplus other than those already presented under paragraph (d) herein above and seek for recommendations
- m) Recommend to the Annual General Meeting the surplus rate to be paid on savings (if any)
- n) Fill vacancies occurring in the management in between Annual General Meetings
- o) Authorize investments of the group in accordance with the investment policy
- p) Recommend by laws to the AGM and implement them after approval
- q) Approve the transfers and withdrawals of savings between members and groups
- r) Ensure repayment of loans and savings contributions by members

Management Sub Committees

There are subcommittees to assist management in carrying out its responsibilities and duties. The subcommittees will be subject to and must comply with the Self-Help Programme Guidelines and policies. The subcommittees are required to report to management after every subcommittee meeting. The subcommittees are Executive Committee, Finance & Budget Committee, Risk, Audit & Compliance Committee and Capacity Building, Strategy & Development Committee. The

committees will carry out the following responsibilities and duties as provided for in the Caritas Nairobi Self Help Programme Governance Manual:

1) Executive Committee

The Executive Committee which comprise the Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson, Secretary and Treasurer has the overall responsibility of providing strategic direction of the SHG. Responsibilities and duties are:

- (i) Executing financial and investment decisions
- (ii) Operational and planning management
- (iii) Staff management
- (iv) Loan approval
- (v)

2) Finance & Budget Committee

The committee comprise three members and is chaired by the Treasurer. The main purpose of this committee is to provide financial oversight for the group. The responsibilities and duties of this committee are:

- (i) Budgeting and financial planning
- (ii) Financial reporting
- (iii) Creation and monitoring of internal controls and accountability of policies
- (iv) Financing the operations of the group in a competent manner
- (v) Procurement process of the SHG
- (vi) Overseeing periodic financial reporting and performance analysis, including comparison of actual results with approved budgets and review of significant variances.
- (vii) Monitoring the implementation of annual business plans and budgets
- (viii) Implementation of the SHG programme Finance and Procurement Policy
- (ix) Review and approval of expense reports from the SHG staff.

3) Risk, Audit & Compliance Committee

The committee comprises three members and is chaired by the executive secretary. The main purpose of this committee is to assist the joint committee in fulfilling its oversight responsibility with respect to the group's risks, audit and compliance functions. The committee will assess the risks associated with the daily group operations and suggest advice and/or make necessary mitigations to risks in compliance with laws, standards and guidelines in place. The responsibilities and duties of this committee are:

- (i) Review the implementation and maintenance of the group's risk management framework and internal control systems

- (ii) Ensure that the group is consistent in principle with the Self-Help Programme Guidelines and Policies
- (iii) Monitor the adequacy of the risk framework and processes to manage risk especially;
 - Credit risk
 - Financial risk
 - Operational risk
 - Governance risk
 - Strategic risk
 - Reputational risk
- (iv) Identify the relevant risk that might affect the ability of the group to achieve its objectives and preserve its assets
- (v) Establish group risk management infrastructure – the people processes and technology to identify, measure, monitor and report on the risks the group faces
- (vi) Establish a compliance management system that seeks to ensure the group's compliance with the application guidelines committee
- (vii) Review the risk appetite, limits and recommendation to the joint committee
- (viii) Provide guidance to the management with respect to establishment, management and implementation of risk and compliance procedures
- (ix) Review non-performing loans (NPLs) and initiate re-allocation
- (x) Approve the process of recovery of defaulted loans
- (xi) Resolve disputes concerning loans
- (xii) Conduct research and development of risks related to new products
- (xiii) Review loan applications from SHG without staff members, with two committee members designated to conduct the appraisal
- (xiv) Discuss with the auditor the nature and scope of the audit to be carried out
- (xv) Review the financial statements before submission to the management
- (xvi) Review the SHG's statement on internet control systems prior to endorsement by the management
- (xvii) Review any significant findings of the internal investigations

4) Capacity Building, Strategy and Development Committee

The committee comprises three members and is chaired by the executive Vice Chairperson. The overarching purpose of this committee is to strengthen the skills, competences, knowledge and abilities of group members to achieve their goals and overcome the causes of their exclusion and distress. The responsibilities and duties of this committee are:

- (i) Conducting training needs assessment (TNA) for the group
- (ii) Engage SHG members and committee members on capacity development

- (iii) Assess capacity needs and assets and identify areas requiring additional training and priority areas
- (iv) Evaluate capacity development by conducting an impact assessment based on the group's performance
- (v) Promote business development
- (vi) Guide on strategic plan formulation, implementation and review
- (vii) Formulate a capacity development response after a proper capacity needs assessment has been conducted based on the group's arrangement, leadership and knowledge levels

5.3 Plan Implementation Matrix

Plan implementation (action plan) matrix indicates what activities are going to be undertaken, by who, when, with what resources, and the expected results. Action plans serve as a link between Plan formulation and monitoring and evaluation; help in both the appraisal of performance and in the identification of any remedial actions and contribute to better motivation of staff through explicit assignments of responsibilities for implementing and monitoring programme. The relevant action plan matrices for the SHG are presented in Annex 1.

CHAPTER SIX: RISK MANAGEMENT

6.1 Introduction

St. Gabriel Catholic Church Thome Self-Help Group (SHG) recognizes that effective risk management is critical to sustaining its mission, protecting its resources, and empowering its members.

The implementation of this Plan is potentially exposed to various risks, among them strategic, operational, financial, and technological risks. SHG will forecast possible risks under these categories and determine mitigation measures as depicted in Table 6.1.

Risk Scoring Chart

Likelihood rating	Impact rating				
	Insignificant (1)	Minor (2)	Moderate (3)	Major (4)	Catastrophic (5)
Almost certain (5)	5	10	15	20	25
Likely (4)	4	8	12	16	20
Possible (3)	3	6	9	12	15
Unlikely (2)	2	4	6	8	10
Rare (1)	1	2	3	4	5

Legend

Colour code	Score	Meaning	Interpretation
Green	1 – 3	Low risk	Accept the risk
Yellow	4 – 8	Medium risk	Manage the risk/Contingency Plan
Amber	9 - 14	High risk	Reduce/Transfer the risk
Red	15 - 25	Very High risk	Avoid the risk

Table 6.1: Risks and Mitigation Measures

	Key Risks	Risk Description	Likelihood of the risk occurring	Impact if the risk occurs	Risk Scoring	Risk Owner	Risk Management Measures
(i)	Strategic risks Governance risks	• Lack of proper oversight through various committees • Unethical practices/leadership • Inadequate capacity and training • Inadequate management	2	3	6	Management Committee	• Policies and procedures guiding operations. • Optimal Committees composition. • Regular reporting by Committees.
	Planning and Resource Allocation	• Failure to document and monitor strategic planning and growth agenda • Inadequate performance management systems • Poor budgeting techniques and control	2	4	8	Management Committee	• Implementation of Strategic Plan 2026-2030 • Proper annual budget and budgetary controls • Establishment of performance management systems and measures
(ii)	Financial Risks						
	Credit Risk	• Borrower default on loans.	3	4	12	Management Committee	• Thorough member credit assessments before loan approval. • Loan limits based on repayment capacity and savings history. • Regular loan portfolio reviews and timely reminders on repayments.

	Key Risks	Risk Description	Likelihood of the risk occurring	Impact if the risk occurs	Risk Scoring	Risk Owner	Risk Management Measures
	Financial reporting	• Ineffective payment and receipts process leading to errors, misstatements and fraud. • The risk that financial reports issued to stakeholders are untimely and/or inaccurate	3	4	12	Management Committee	• Proper financial and administrative policies guiding financial operations • Periodic reviews and audits providing assurance
	Interest rate risk	• Unfavourable interest rates • Financial losses due to interest rate exposures	2	4	8	Management Committee	• Negotiated interest rate on fixed deposits placed with the bank. • Monitoring of investment portfolio ensuring prudent investment strategies to generate more income on investments.
	Liquidity risks	• Lack of liquidity oversight at management committee level • Insufficient cash or assets to meet obligations.	2	4	8	Management Committee	• Constant monitoring of liquidity position and taking corrective actions where necessary. • Maintain cash reserves proportionate to expected withdrawals. • Monitor liquidity regularly and adjust lending accordingly.

	Key Risks	Risk Description	Likelihood of the risk occurring	Impact if the risk occurs	Risk Scoring	Risk Owner	Risk Management Measures
(iii)	Operational Risks						
	Community and Religious Sensitivity	• Actions perceived as insensitive or harmful to faith and community values.	2	3	6	Management Committee	• Align all products, programmes and communications with Catholic Church teachings. • Engage community leaders and members regularly for feedback. • Sensitivity training for all SHG leaders and staff.
	Cybersecurity and Data Protection	• Loss, theft, or unauthorized access to member and SHG data.	4	4	16	Management Committee	• Implement strong passwords and access controls. • Regular backups and updates of IT infrastructure. • Train staff in cybersecurity with the best practices and data protection laws.
	Transaction risks	• Lack of clear policies guiding operations • Delayed financial records reconciliations resulting to inaccurate reporting and decision making.	2	3	6	Management Committee	• Adoption of proper policies and procedure guidelines • Effective internal control systems • Automation of processes

	Key Risks	Risk Description	Likelihood of the risk occurring	Impact if the risk occurs	Risk Scoring	Risk Owner	Risk Management Measures
	Human resources	• SHG failure to attract and retain employees with the requisite knowledge, skills and experience • Failure to develop and enhance employee skills and provide performance management that ensures optimal achievement of staff and organizational strategies, goals and objectives	2	4	8	Management Committee	• Development and adoption of human resources policy • Structured capacity building for staff • Human resources skills audit
	Information Communication Technology	• Inadequate IT infrastructure to support current and future achievement of objectives. • SHG does not have a mechanism to monitor routine processes or address technology issues in a timely manner.	3	4	12	Management Committee	• Continuous upgrading and adoption of current ICT infrastructure and systems. • Periodic maintenance of ICT equipment. • Regular back-up of data and information.
	Fraud and Internal Control	• Fraud, errors or mismanagement.	2	4	8	Management Committee	• Segregation of duties in financial management. • Regular audits and surprise checks.
	Political risk	• National and County governments change of policies leading to operational challenges	2	4	8	Management Committee	• Lobbying • Diversify activities

Continuous efforts will be put in place to alleviate inappropriate risk culture across the organization by ensuring a strong and consistent intent at management and staff levels on all matters relating to risk management. Leadership at Management Committee and operational levels will actively demonstrate commitment to ethical conduct, accountability, and prudent risk-taking through clear policies, decision-making practices, and performance management systems. Risk management training and culture surveys will be conducted periodically, accompanied by structured follow-ups to ensure that findings, recommendations, and corrective actions arising from the surveys are effectively implemented and embedded within day-to-day operations.

In addition, management committee will establish a continuous monitoring and learning framework to track progress in improving risk culture. This will involve regular reporting on risk culture indicators, lessons learned from incidents and near misses, and emerging internal or external risks. Insights from these reviews will be used to refine policies, update training programme, and enhance controls, ensuring that risk management remains dynamic and aligned with SHG strategic objectives.

CHAPTER SEVEN: RESOURCE MOBILIZATION

7.1 Resource Mobilization

Successful implementation of the Strategic Plan will depend not only on the quality and commitment of SHG leaders and staff but also on the availability and efficient utilisation of other resources.

7.2 Budgetary Requirements

The projected funds required for implementing the pertinent strategies, programmes and projects outlined in this Plan are summarized in Table 7.1.

Table 7.1: Summary of Budgetary Requirements for Each Objective (KES)

Objective	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	TOTAL COST
1	184,000.00	114,000.00	114,000.00	114,000.00	114,000.00	640,000.00
2	25,000.00	25,000.00	25,000.00	25,000.00	25,000.00	125,000.00
3	10,000.00	10,000.00	10,000.00	10,000.00	10,000.00	50,000.00
4	172,500.00	183,800.00	183,800.00	183,800.00	183,800.00	907,700.00
5	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
6	115,000.00	170,000.00	170,000.00	170,000.00	170,000.00	795,000.00
Sub Total	506,500.00	502,800.00	502,800.00	502,800.00	502,800.00	2,517,700.00
Operating Expenses	3,614,500.00	4,435,800.00	5,182,500.00	5,923,900.00	6,691,800.00	25,848,500.00
Total	4,121,000.00	4,938,600.00	5,685,300.00	6,426,700.00	7,194,600.00	28,366,200.00

Key:

Objective 1: Increase membership by 20% in 2026 and 2027 and by 10% thereafter
(Baseline = 376 members)

Objective 2: Grow share capital by 25% annually (Baseline = KES 87 million)

Objective 3: Increase loan uptake by 6% annually

Objective 4: Enhance governance, risk management and human resource capacity

Objective 5: Enhance application of ICT in management decision making and service delivery

Objective 6: Promote environmental sustainability and positive social impact

7.3 Sources of Revenue

The revenue sources are summarized in Table 7.2.

Table 7.2: Summary of Revenues by Source (KES)

Source	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total
Loan interest	3,279,700.00	4,427,500.00	5,977,200.00	7,770,300.00	10,489,900.00	31,944,600.00
Investment income	7,194,000.00	8,425,200.00	9,860,000.00	12,084,000.00	14,896,000.00	52,459,200.00
Other incomes	70,800.00	81,500.00	96,100.00	115,400.00	143,000.00	506,800.00
Gross income	10,544,500.00	12,934,200.00	15,933,300.00	19,969,700.00	25,529,000.00	84,910,600.00

Table 7.3: Financial Summary (KES)

Item Description	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total
Total Revenues	10,544,500.00	12,934,200.00	15,933,300.00	19,969,700.00	25,529,000.00	84,910,600.00
Total Expenditures	4,121,000.00	4,938,600.00	5,685,300.00	6,426,700.00	7,194,600.00	28,366,200.00
Surplus/ Deficit	6,423,500.00	7,995,600.00	10,248,000.00	13,543,000.00	18,334,400.00	56,544,400.00

CHAPTER EIGHT: MONITORING, EVALUATION, REPORTING & LEARNING

8.1 Introduction

Monitoring the implementation of the business plan constitutes a systematic tracking of activities and actions to assess progress. Progress will be measured against specific target metrics and schedules included in the Plan. The action plan helps the users to remain alert to any short-falls or deviations and take early corrective action. Effective monitoring helps to identify difficulties and problem areas, and to take immediate remedial action, thereby ensuring that the relevant targets are achieved. Regular reporting at all levels is necessary for follow-up and record keeping.

8.2 Strategies for Monitoring and Evaluation (M & E)

The following are the strategies that will be used in monitoring and evaluating the implementation of the Plan.

8.2.1 Sustainability Balanced Scorecard (SBSC)

The Sustainability Balanced Scorecard recognizes the growing importance of sustainability in today's business environment. It expands upon the traditional BSC by adding a fifth perspective that specifically addresses sustainability and environmental performance. This perspective considers the environmental impact and sustainability practices of an organization, helping it to align its business strategy with sustainability goals. The key components of the Sustainability Balanced Scorecard include:

- **Financial Perspective:** This perspective still includes traditional financial Key Performance Indicators (KPIs), but it also factors in the financial implications of sustainability initiatives and investments, such as cost savings from energy efficiency measures or increased revenue from sustainable products. Some of the KPIs to be tracked include share capital, amount of loans issued, investment income among others.
- **Customer Perspective:** In the context of sustainability, this perspective considers customer expectations and preferences related to sustainability and how well SHG meets those expectations. One of the key KPIs to be tracked in this perspective is the membership satisfaction index.
- **Internal Processes Perspective:** This perspective evaluates the efficiency and sustainability of internal processes, including supply chain management, waste reduction, and resource efficiency. Some of the KPIs to be monitored include average turnaround time for loan disbursement from application to

payout; amount of administrative and operational expenses; and ICT equipment user-to-device ratio (number of users per workstation/device).

- **Learning and Growth Perspective:** It assesses SHG capacity to innovate and adapt to changing sustainability requirements, including employee training and development in sustainability practices. Under learning and growth, the SHG will monitor number of SHG leaders and members trained.
- **Sustainability Perspective:** This perspective focuses on SHG environmental and social impact. It measures key performance indicators related to environmental sustainability, such as carbon emissions, water usage, waste reduction, and social responsibility initiatives. SHG will track the amount of reserves (KES) and new member acquisition rate among others.

SBSC is a valuable tool for SHG to integrate sustainability into its core business strategies and monitor their progress toward sustainability goals. By aligning sustainability metrics with the traditional performance management framework, SHG can ensure that sustainability is not treated as separate or peripheral concern but is an integral part of its overall strategy and performance management. This will help SHG to improve its environmental and social responsibility while also achieving financial and operational success.

8.2.2 Plan Implementation Champion/Team

The Capacity Building, Strategy and Development Committee (CBSDC) will follow up and ensure that strategies are being implemented, performance measured, progress reports are made and discussed, and corrective action is taken where necessary. Monitoring and evaluation will have little value if SHG does not act on the information that comes out of pertinent data analysis. Once the Committee has the findings, conclusions and recommendations from the monitoring and evaluation process, it shall report to stakeholders; learn from the overall process; and make decisions about how to move forward.

8.2.3 Cascading the Plan

The Strategic Plan must be translated to work. The Plan and its targets will therefore be cascaded to the relevant positions/committees in the Group. Detailed annual work plans with clear performance indicators and assigned responsibilities for their achievement will be developed. Key performance indicators that inform management decision making have been identified and the frequency of reporting on these indicators will be determined. This will form the foundation of the Monitoring and Evaluation (M & E) system and the Sustainability Balanced Scorecard.

8.2.4 Committee and Individual Annual Work Plans

Detailed annual work plans with clear performance (measures) indicators and assigned responsibilities for their achievement will be developed. Key indicators that will inform management decision making will be identified and the frequency of reporting on these indicators will be determined. This will form the foundation of the Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) system.

8.2.5 Periodic Meetings

Monthly Review Meetings at the Management Committee level will be scheduled to ensure implementation is on track. Quarterly review meetings at the standing committee level will be scheduled to receive and give feedback on the pertinent performance indicators. The overall oversight of the Strategic Plan and its implementation is a critical role of the Management Committee.

8.2.6 Conclusion

Implementation of the strategies and action programmes outlined in this Plan will enable SHG to capitalize on its strengths and overcome its weaknesses; take advantage of emerging opportunities especially those related to technological advances; and to address any challenges posed by both national and global operating environments. This will in turn enable SHG to achieve its Vision and accomplish its Mission for the benefit of stakeholders.

Annexes

Annex 1: Implementation (Action Plan) Matrices

Objective 1: Increase membership by 20% in 2026 and 2027 and by 10% thereafter (Baseline = 376 members)

					Output/Target						Cost in KES							
	Strategy	Activity	Time Frame (By when)	Performance (Measure) Indicator	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	Responsibility/C hampions	Notes and assumptions
1.1	Enhance membership recruitment drive within St. Gabriel Catholic Church	1.1.1 Enhance service desk at St. Gabriel Church entrance	Continually	Enhanced service desk in place	24	24	24	24	24	120	24,000.00	24,000.00	24,000.00	24,000.00	24,000.00	120,000.00	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	Information desk twice a month with 2 people @500 each
		1.1.2 Expand Jumuiya based, referrals, activation drives, recruitment through local drive memberships	Annually	No. of new members	23	27	16	18	20	104	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	
		1.1.3 Make announcements in Church	Monthly	No. of announcements made	24	24	24	24	24	120	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	
		1.1.4 Use digital outreach strategies such as Website TikTok and WhatsApp.	Continually	No. of social media channels used	3	3	3	3	3	3	25,000.00	25,000.00	25,000.00	25,000.00	25,000.00	125,000.00	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	Cost of content development, posters, videos etc. at roughly 2000 per month
		1.1.5 Introduce and conduct financial literacy programmes	Quarterly	No. of programmes	4	4	4	4	4	20	30,000.00	30,000.00	30,000.00	30,000.00	30,000.00	150,000.00	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	Breakfast session, high teas or other forums serving tea, starch and protein @150 targeting 50 people per quarter
			Annually	No. of people trained	100	12	140	160	180	700	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	
		1.1.6 Develop and implement reward system for referrals	Continually	Reward system in place	1	1	1	1	1	1						-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	
			Continually	No. of new members	11	14	8	9	1	52	25,000.00	25,000.00	25,000.00	25,000.00	25,000.00	125,000.00	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	Rewarding the best 5 each quarter as per pre-determined criteria, gift items costing at most 1000
1.2	Attract membership from Catholics and Non-Catholics from the environs of St. Gabriel Catholic Church	1.2.1 Use existing members as Ambassadors	Continuous	No. of new members recruited	11	14	8	9	10	52	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	
		1.2.2 Develop and launch an active SHG website	April 2026	Website developed and operational	1	1	1	1	1	1	50,000.00	25,000.00	25,000.00	25,000.00	25,000.00	250,000.00	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	Estimate cost of developing the website and subsequent update and maintenance cost.

					Output/Target						Cost in KES							
	Strategy	Activity	Time Frame (By when)	Performance (Measure) indicator	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	Responsibility/C hampions	Notes and assumptions
		1.2.3 Conduct recruitment campaigns	Quarterly	No. of recruitment campaigns	4	4	4	4	4	20						-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	To be covered by same activities in 1.1.5
			Quarterly	No. of new members recruited	19	23	11	12	16	81	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	
		1.2.4 Develop and implement reward system for referrals	Continually	Reward system in place	1	1	1	1	1	1						-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	To be covered by same activities in 1.1.6
				No. of new members	11	12	11	11	9	54						-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	
1.3	Develop and implement member retention programmes	1.3.1 Carry out orientation sessions/new members onboarding	Quarterly	No. of onboarding sessions	4	4	4	4	4	20	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	To be covered by same activities in 1.1.5
		1.3.2 Introduce buddy/mentorship system for new members	April 2026 and annually thereafter	Buddy system in place	1	1	1	1	1	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	To be covered by same activities in 1.1.5
		1.3.3 Follow-up with monthly welcome messages and onboarding support	Continually	No. of monthly messages	12	12	12	12	12	60	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	To be covered by same activities in 1.1.4
		1.3.4 Carry out member satisfaction survey	Annually	Member satisfaction index (%)	80	85	87	89	90	90	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	Survey design and analysis to be done by the Accounts assistant with support from management
											254,000	129,000	129,000	129,000	129,000	770,000		

Objective 2: Grow share capital by 25% annually (Baseline = KES 87 million)

						Output/Target for each year						Cost in KES							
	Strategy	Activity	Time Frame (By when)	Performance (Measure) indicator	Baseline (2025)	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	Responsibility	Notes and assumptions
2.1	Develop and implement reward system for referrals for the youth	2.1.1 Introduce incentives specifically for the youth	Annually	No. of youth members	101	135	162	178	196	215	215	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	To be covered by same activities in 1.1.6
		2.1.2 Monitor and evaluate incentives system	Quarterly	No. of reports		4	4	4	4	4	20	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	
2.2	Maintain a minimum annual share capital growth of 25%	2.2.1 Monitor share capital growth	Quarterly and annually	Amount of share capital in KES (Million)	87	109	136	170	212	266	266	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	
		2.2.2 Develop and introduce innovative and flexible savings products for diverse incomes	Annually	No. of innovative products		2	1	1	1	1	6	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	
2.3	Educate members on the value of savings	2.3.1 Conduct financial literacy and investments seminars	Quarterly	No. of seminars conducted		4	4	4	4	4	20	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	To be covered by same activities in 1.1.5
			Quarterly	No. of people trained		80	120	150	180	220	750	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	
		2.3.2 Develop and distribute financial literacy and investment materials.	Continually	Frequency of materials distribution		Daily	Daily	Daily	Daily	Daily	Daily	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	Leverage on digital information sharing reduce printing for sustainability covered under 1.1.4
		2.3.3 Undertake benchmarking visits	Annually	No. of visits conducted		1	1	1	1	1	5	25,000	30,000	35,000	40,000	45,000	175,000	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	Prorated from this 2025's 9,000 before management cost. Assuming cost of hosting a bench marking - 15,000, and growing by 5,000 each year
	Total											25,000	30,000	35,000	40,000	45,000	175,000		

Objective 3: Increase loan uptake by 6% annually

						Output/Target for each year						Cost in KES							
	Strategy	Activity	Time Frame (By when)	Performance (Measure) indicator	Baseline (2025)	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	Responsibility	Notes and assumptions
3.1	Review and streamline loan processes, reducing turnaround time	3.1.1 Conduct assessment of loan approval process	Continually	Report	-	1	1	1	1	1	5	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	
			Continually	Reduced loan processing days	7	3	1	1	1	1	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	Internal process alignment and leveraging on any available technology
			Annually	Loan uptake rate (%)	33	39	45	51	57	63	63	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	
		3.1.2 Introduce simplified digital loan application forms and approval	2026 - 2030	% of digital applications submitted	-	50	60	75	80	90	90	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	To be incorporated when the website is developed.
3.2	Strengthen guarantor mobilization through Group guarantorship clusters (cells)	3.2.1 Establish and train guarantor clusters per Jumuiya/cell	March 2026	No. of clusters operational	2	4	6	8	10	12	12	10,000	10,000	10,000	10,000	10,000	50,000	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	Assumed cost of hosting physical meetings or paying a facilitator if need be
		3.2.2 Develop guarantor mobilization guidelines	June 2026	Approved and roll out guidelines in place	To check availability of guarantor cell guidelines	Approved guidelines	Fully Implemented	Update	Update	Update		-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	
3.3	Expand member education on available loan products	3.3.1 Conduct quarterly member sensitization sessions	Quarterly	No. of sensitization sessions held		4	4	4	4	4	20	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	To be covered by same activities in 1.1.5
		3.3.2 Develop a loan product handbook (physical + digital)	December 2026	Loan handbook available in physical and digital form		Handbook in place	Handbook in place	Updated	Handbook in place	Handbook in place		-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	To be done by the accounts assistant
3.4	Introduce loan uptake campaigns and loyalty rewards	3.4.1 Launch annual loan uptake campaigns	Quarterly	No. of campaigns		4	4	4	4	4	20	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	To be covered by same activities in 1.1.5
		3.4.2 Introduce loyalty reward scheme for consistent borrowers	Annually	No. of members rewarded		10	20	30	40	50	150	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building Sub-Committee	To be covered by same activities in 1.1.6
	Total											10,000	10,000	10,000	10,000	10,000	50,000		

Objective 4: Enhance governance, risk management and human resource capacity

						Output/Target for each year						Cost in KES							
	Strategy	Activity	Time frame	Performance Indicator	Baseline (2025)	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	Responsibility	Notes and assumptions
4.1	Review existing governance systems	4.1.1 Effective implementation of policies,	December 2026	Number of documented procedures		4	4	4	4	4	4	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	
		Develop and implement procedures										-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	
		4.1.2 Strengthen Risk Management, Audit and Compliance Functions	Continually	Level of compliance (%)		100	100	100	100	100	100	-	-	-	-	-	-	Risk, Audit and Compliance	
			Quarterly	No. and quality of audit reports		4	4	4	4	4	20	-	-	-	-	-	-	Risk, Audit and Compliance	
4.2	Transition from Management Committee to governance driven Board Structure	4.2.1 Map and identify relevant skills	April 2026	Report		1	Update	Update	Update	Update	5	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building	
		4.2.2 Carry out recruitment	2029	Board in Place					Board in Place			-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	
		4.2.3 Benchmark with similar institutions	Annually	Visit reports		1	1	1	1	1	5	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	
4.3	Strengthen the Group's leadership capacity	4.3.1 Conduct a needs assessment	Jan-26	Report		1	1	1	1	1	5	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building	
		4.3.2 Develop capacity building programmes	Annually	Training manual and programmes		1	1	1	1	1	5	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building	
			Annually	Number of trainings		1	1	1	1	1	5	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building	
		4.3.3 Conduct capacity building programmes	Annually	Number of people trained		7	7	7	7	7	35	40,000	50,000	50,000	50,000	50,000	240,000.	Capacity Building	Accounting for one day duty allowance, facilitation fee and refreshments
4.4	Develop and implement a mentorship and succession planning framework	4.4.1 Attract and retain members	Annually	Number of members retained (%)		10%	10%	10%	10%	10%	50%	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	
		4.4.2 Organize consultative meetings with former management committee members.	Annually	Number of meetings		1	1	1	1	1	1	5	50,000	50,000	50,000	50,000	250,000	Management Committee	Retaining the 2025 expense of 50,000

						Output/Target for each year						Cost in KES							
	Strategy	Activity	Time frame	Performance Indicator	Baseline (2025)	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	Responsibility	Notes and assumptions
		4.4.3 Establish a cloud -based server/database	Mar-26	Database in place		1	1	1	1	1	1	5	3,800	3,800	3,800	3,800	17,700	Management Committee	Cost of google cloud space
		4.4.4 Improve communication with members and other stakeholders.	Continually	Satisfaction indices (%)		80	85	87	89	90	90	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	To be done through digital communications
4.5	Enhance performance management systems (PMS)	4.5.1 Develop a service charter	Apr-26	Service charter in place		1	Reviewed	Reviewed	Reviewed	Reviewed		-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	
		4.5.2 Sensitize staff and implement the PMS	Quarterly	No. of Sensitization forums		4	4	4	4	4	20	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	80,000	400,000	Management Committee	Cost of Staff training for 2 staff
			Annually	No. of staff sensitized and Performance Contracts signed		2	2	2	2	2	2	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building	
	Total											172,500	183,800	183,800	183,800	183,800	907,700		

Objective 5: Enhance application of ICT in management decision making and service delivery

						Output/Target for each year						Cost in KES							
	Strategy	Activity	Time Frame (By when)	Performance (Measure) indicator	Baseline (2025)	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	Responsibility	Notes and Assumptions
5.1	Develop and operationalize the SHG website	5.1.1 Develop and launch a fully functional SHG website	April 2026	Website operational		1	1	1	1	1	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	Costed under objective 1
		5.1.2 Integrate online membership and loan applications	Annually	% of applications submitted digitally		30	60	80	90	95	95	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	Costed under objective 1
5.2	Digitize operations: records, reporting, communication	5.2.1 Digitize all SHG records (member data, minutes, reports)	2026-2027	% of records digitized		10	50	100	100	100	100	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	To be done gradually by SHG staff
		5.2.2 Introduce digital communication platforms	2026-2030	No. of active digital communication channels		4	5	5	6	6	6	-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	Costed under Objective 1
5.3	Adopt data analytics and research planning for decision-making	5.3.1 Implement basic business analytics dashboard	Continually	Dashboard operational			Design Dashboard	Operational	Update	Update		-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	To be done by the SHG staff and the Management
												-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	
		5.3.2 Train management on evidence-based decision-making	Annually	No. of management/ staff trained		9	9	9	9	9		-	-	-	-	-	-	Management Committee	Covered under Objective 4 (4.3.3)
												-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building	
5.4	Conduct ICT training for staff, management, and members	5.4.1 Provide ICT literacy training for all staff and leadership	Annually	No. of people trained		9	9	9	9	9	9	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building	Covered under Objective 4 (4.3.3)
		5.4.2 Conduct member ICT training	Annually	% of members trained		30	50	70	80	90	90	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building	
		5.4.3 Establish an ICT helpdesk / support line	December 2026	Helpdesk fully operational		1	1	1	1	1	1	-	-	-	-	-	-	Capacity Building	To be incorporated on the website, social media channels, and all available cost effective communication channels.
	Total											-	-	-	-	-	-		

Objective 6: Promote environmental sustainability and positive social impact

						Output/Target for each year						Cost in KES							
	Strategy	Activity	Time Frame (By when)	Performance (Measure) indicator	Baseline (2025)	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	Responsibility	Notes and Assumptions
6.1	Institutionalize green practices (recycling, reduced printing, energy efficiency etc.)	6.1.1 Reduce paper usage through digitalization	Annually	% reduction in printing costs	24,490	20	40	50	60	70	70	-	-	-	-	-		Management Committee	Costed under digitalization in Objective 1
		6.1.2 Introduce waste separation & recycling in SHG operations	April 2026	No. of recycling stations		1	1	1	1	1	1	-	-	-	-	-		Management Committee	Management to assess the need to introduce waste separation bins for the SHG or the church to inform the cost - A one off cost of bins can be incurred from the CSI budget
		6.1.3 Promote energy efficiency	Annually	% electricity consumption reduced		10	20	20	20	20	20	-	-	-	-	-		Management Committee	
		6.1.4 Hold tree planting exercise	Annually	Number of trees planted	To be updated							-	-	-	-	-		Management Committee	Management suggest number of trees we can plant and cost to inform the figure A cost can be allocated from the annual CSI budget and dedicated towards tree seedlings.
6.2	Expand annual Corporate Social Investment (CSI) activities	6.2.1 Organize annual community service events	Annually	No. of CSI events held		1	2	2	3	3	11	-	-	-	-	-		Management Committee	
		6.2.1 Allocate annual CSI budget for education & vulnerable groups	Annually	Amount spent on CSI (KES Millions)		0.10	0.20	0.30	0.30	0.30	1.20	100,000	160,000	160,000	160,000	160,000	740,000	Management Committee	
		6.2.2 Publish annual CSI report	Annually	No. of CSI reports		1	1	1	1	1	5	5,000	-	-	-	-	5,000	Management Committee	Contract a graphic designer to design our templates in the first year and use them in the subsequent years.

						Output/Target for each year						Cost in KES							
	Strategy	Activity	Time Frame (By when)	Performance (Measure) indicator	Baseline (2025)	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030	Total	Responsibility	Notes and Assumptions
6.3	Collaborate with stakeholders on environmental projects	6.3.1 Partner on green initiatives	Annually	No. of joint projects		1	2	2	2	2	9	-	-	-	-	-		Management Committee	
		6.3.2 Sponsor environmental awareness campaigns	Quarterly	No. of awareness sessions		4	4	4	4	4	20	-	-	-	-	-		Management Committee	
6.4	Develop youth-led environmental volunteer programmes	6.4.1 Create SHG Youth Green Champions Programme	Annually	No. of Green Champions		5	10	15	20	25	25	-	-	-	-	-		Management Committee	
		6.4.2 Organize youth environmental actions	Annually	No. of youth-led events		1	1	1	1	1	5	10,000	10,000	10,000	10,000	10,000	50,000	Management Committee	Cost of support or promotional material for youth - led activities
	Total											115,000	170,000	170,000	170,000	170,000	795,000		

NOTES

[illegible]

NOTES

[illegible]

STRATEGIC PLAN 2026-2030



Save • Borrow • Grow

CONTACT US



+254 715 590 028



shg@thomecaritasnairobi.org
scgabrielshg@gmail.com



St. Gabriel Catholic Church, Thome.
1st floor above PMC Chapel
Mon-Fri: 8:00 am-5:00 pm
Every Fourth Sunday of the month till 1pm